Paisa Vault

Pocket Guide

What to tap when real life happens: a payment, a bank SMS, a card bill, a lost phone.

Your app

https://dev21-22.github.io/paisa-vault/

Works offline once installed. Your data stays encrypted on your own devices.

The one rule

Nobody can recover your master password, not even the app's maker. Write it on paper, keep it safe, and make a backup file every week or two.

Guide for the version released October 2026.

Contents

1	First-day setup checklist
2	Everyday money moments
3	Bank accounts & credit cards
4	Splitting bills with friends & family
5	Budgets, bills & planning ahead
6	Finding things & understanding your spending
7	Phone, laptop & syncing
8	Security & emergencies
9	Quick reference: screens, words, tips

How the app is laid out

PLACE	WHAT'S THERE
Home	This month's spending, budget left, bills due, card dues, 30-day forecast, recent entries.
History	Every entry, with search and filters.
+ button	Add an expense, income or transfer. Always in the middle of the bottom bar (bottom-right on a laptop).
Reports	Charts, spending calendar, insights.
Accounts	Banks, cards, cash, net worth.
More	Split with friends, Budgets, Bills & subscriptions, Savings goals, Lent & borrowed, Categories, Backup & sync, Settings.
👁 / 🔒 (top right)	Blur all amounts / lock the app now.

1 · First-day setup checklist

Ten minutes once, and the app does most of the work after that.

- ☐ **Create your master password.** Use a short sentence, like *my-dog-eats-3-mangoes!*, and write it on paper.
- ☐ **Add every bank account.** `Accounts → Add account`. Enter the name, bank, **last 4 digits** and today's balance. For a bank with a minimum-balance rule, enter it.
- ☐ **Add each credit card.** Type: Credit card. Enter the last 4 digits, the amount owed now, the credit limit, the **statement date** and the **due date**.
- ☐ **Set your Cash balance.** Open **Cash**, then `Update balance`.
- ☐ **Salary not on the 1st?** `More → Settings → Month starts on`. Pick your salary day.
- ☐ **Add fixed bills.** `More → Bills & subscriptions → Add`. Rent, EMIs, phone, OTT, SIPs. Tick *Add it automatically* for fixed ones like rent or salary.
- ☐ **Set a monthly budget.** `More → Budgets`, then tap *All spending*.
- ☐ **Optional: bring in history.** Import last month's bank statement (see section 3).
- ☐ **Install on phone and laptop** (section 7) and make your **first backup**.

Why last 4 digits matter

When you paste a bank SMS like "debited from A/c XX1234", the app picks the right account by itself. With 2–3 banks this saves the most time.

2 · Everyday money moments

"I just paid for something."

Tap **+**, type the amount, tap a category, then **Save**. The category is often picked for you as you type the note (Swiggy → Food, Uber → Travel).

Tip: the amount box does maths. Type **250+120** and it saves ₹370.

"I got a debit or credit SMS from my bank."

Copy the SMS, then tap **+ → Paste bank SMS**, paste it and tap **Fill from SMS**. It fills in the amount, merchant, date, expense or income, and the account (from its last 4 digits). Check it, then Save. The SMS text itself is never stored.

"I buy the same thing again and again."

After you've added something twice (tea ₹20, metro ₹40), it appears as a **Quick add** button at the top of the + screen. One tap fills everything.

"One bill covers different things." (DMart: groceries + household)

In the + screen, tap **Split across categories**. Add a row per category and give each an amount. The app shows what's left to assign until it adds up.

"I withdrew cash from an ATM."

This isn't spending, just moving money. Tap **+ → Transfer**, choose From: *your bank* and To: *Cash*. When you spend that cash later, add those expenses from **Cash**. Statement imports do this for you.

"I moved money between my own accounts / topped up a wallet / paid my card bill."

Always use **Transfer**. Transfers never count as income or spending, so your reports stay correct.

"My salary came in."

+ → Income → Salary, received in your salary account. Better: set it up once in **Bills & subscriptions** as **Income** with *Add automatically*.

"I got a refund or cashback."

Add it as **Income** with the category *Interest & returns*, or as an income in the original category if you prefer.

"I lent money to a friend." / "I borrowed from family."

For a shared bill (dinner, cab, rent), use **Split with friends** (section 4). For a plain loan, use **More → Lent & borrowed → Add**. When they pay back, even in parts, tap **Repayment**. The top shows *Others owe you* and *You owe*.

"I entered something wrong."

Tap the entry anywhere (Home, History, an account) to edit it, or tap **Delete**. A deleted entry can be brought back with **Undo** for a few seconds.

"I want to group spending for a trip or event."

Add a **tag** like *goa-trip* to each entry. Search **#goa-trip** in History to see them all, and check **Reports → By tag** for the total.

3 · Bank accounts & credit cards

"The app's balance doesn't match my bank."

Open the account, tap **Update balance** and type what your bank app shows. The app adds a **balance correction** for the difference. Corrections don't count as spending or income. Do this monthly for each account.

"I don't want to type months of old transactions."

1. In your bank's net banking, download the **statement as CSV**. If you only get Excel, open it and *Save as → CSV*.
2. **Accounts → Import statement**. Pick the account, then choose the file.
3. Check the list. Categories are pre-filled, entries you already have are unticked, and ATM withdrawals become transfers to Cash.
4. Tap **Import**. Importing the same file twice is safe; duplicates are detected.

"When is my credit card bill due, and how much?"

Open the card in **Accounts**:

- **Bill due:** the amount from the last statement still unpaid, and its due date.
- **Unbilled:** spent since the last statement; it goes on the next bill.
- **Limit used:** stay under 30% for a healthier credit score.

Home shows a reminder 7 days before the due date. Tap **Pay** or **Pay card bill** to record the payment as a transfer from your bank.

"I spent on my credit card."

Add a normal **Expense** with *Paid from* set to the card. It counts as spending now. Paying the bill later is a transfer, so nothing is counted twice.

"My bank charges a fee if I go below the minimum balance."

Edit the account and set **Minimum balance**. If the balance drops below it, a red alert appears on Home.

"How much am I really worth?"

Accounts shows **Net worth** (what you own minus card and loan dues) with a 12-month chart. To leave an account out, such as a joint account, untick *Count in net worth*.

> **"I closed a bank account."**
> Edit it and tick **Account closed**. It disappears from pickers but its history stays in your reports.

Account types

Bank account · Credit card · Cash · UPI / wallet · Loan · Investment / FD · Other. Credit cards and loans count as money you *owe*.

4 · Splitting bills with friends & family

More → Split with friends. Your reports count **only your share** of any shared bill. The rest is tracked as money owed.

"I paid for dinner for all of us."

Tap **Split a bill**, enter what it was for and the total, and pick who shared it (you're included). Leave *Paid by: You* and *Equally*. The app shows your share and what the others owe you. Your bank balance drops by the full bill, but only your share counts as spending.

"A friend paid, and I owe them my part."

Same screen, but set **Paid by** to your friend. Your share counts as spending now. Your bank balance changes only when you settle up.

"I paid for someone else's ticket or order."

Tap **I paid for someone** (or open the person and tap *I paid for …*). They owe the full amount and none of it counts as your spending.

"We didn't split it equally."

Pick a split method:

- **Exact ₹** for set amounts per person
- **%** for percentages
- **Shares** for ratios, e.g. 2:1:1 when a couple shares a room with two singles

The app tells you if the numbers don't add up.

"We're going on a trip / I share a flat."

New group. Name it, pick an icon and add members. Every bill in the group picks everyone in one tap. The group page shows the total spent, your share, who paid what, and each person's balance with you. Tick *Finished* after the trip to hide it.

"Someone paid me back." / "I paid my friend back."

Settle up. Pick the person, choose *They paid me* or *I paid them*, enter the amount (full or part), and choose the account. It moves money but never counts as spending or income.

"I need to remind someone politely."

Open the person and tap **Send reminder**. You get a ready message listing the bills and the amount. **Copy** it, **Share** it, or open **WhatsApp**. Add your UPI ID in **Settings** so the message includes it and a tap-to-pay UPI link. Nothing is sent unless you send it.

"I already started adding it as a normal expense."

In the **+** screen, tap **Split with friends**. The amount, note, category and account carry over.

Where balances show

Home has a **Friends** card (owed to you / you owe). The Split with friends screen shows totals, groups and people. Tap a person for their full history. Shared bills in History show "Your share ₹..." or "Paid by ...".

5 · Budgets, bills & planning ahead

"I want to control my spending this month."

More → Budgets. Set *All spending* and any category limits. Then:

- Home shows **money left** and how much you can **safely spend per day**.
- From day 5, a **pace warning** appears if you're heading over budget.
- Categories at 80% or more appear under **Budget alerts**.
- Tick **Roll over** to carry unspent money into next month's limit.

"I have rent, EMI, phone and OTT bills every month."

More → Bills & subscriptions → Add. For each one, choose:

- **Reminder:** it appears on Home 7 days early. Tap **Mark paid** when you pay.
- **Add automatically:** recorded by itself on the due date. Good for fixed amounts like rent or salary.

The top shows your fixed costs per month and per year.

"I forgot to add a subscription."

The app notices payments that repeat (same name, similar amount, regular gap) and shows **Looks like a regular payment** on Home. Tap **Track** to add it, or ✕ to ignore it.

"Will my money last until salary day?"

Home → **Next 30 days** lists what's coming in and going out from your bills and regular income, and the cash left afterwards. A red warning shows the date your bank and cash balance could go below zero.

"I'm saving for a phone, a trip or an emergency fund."

More → Savings goals → New goal. Set a target and date, and the app tells you how much to save each month. Tap **Add money** whenever you put some aside.

"My salary comes on the 25th, so calendar months don't make sense."

Settings → Month starts on → 25th. Every screen then uses 25th-to-24th periods.

6 · Finding things & understanding spending

"Where did I pay that ₹1,299?"

History → search. You can search for:

- words: *amazon*, *petrol*
- amounts: *1299*
- tags: *#office*
- a category name

Switch between **Month** and **All time**. Open **Filters** for type, category, account and minimum/maximum amount.

"Where is my money going?"

Reports for any month (use the arrows):

- **Spending by category:** tap a row to see those entries.
- **Insights:** change vs last month, savings rate, biggest increase, largest expense, and the weekday you spend most.
- **Daily spending:** the dashed line is your daily average.
- **Last 6 months:** income vs spending.
- **Spending calendar:** darker days mean more spending, plus a count of no-spend days.
- **Spending by account** and **By tag**.

"The app keeps picking the wrong category for a shop."

More → Categories → Add rule. For example, *contains "milkman"* → Groceries. Tick *re-categorise past entries* to fix old ones too.

"I need the data in Excel for taxes or a CA."

More → Backup & sync → Export CSV. **This file is not encrypted.** Delete it once you're done.

"I want my own categories."

More → Categories. Add, rename, or pick an icon and colour. Deleting a category moves its entries to *Other*.

7 · Phone, laptop & syncing

Install

DEVICE	STEPS
Android	Open the link in Chrome, tap ⋮, then **Install app** / **Add to Home screen**.
iPhone	Open the link in Safari, tap Share, then **Add to Home Screen**.
Laptop	Open the link in Chrome or Edge, then click the install icon in the address bar.

"I added entries on my phone; I want them on my laptop."

1. Phone: **More → Backup & sync → Create backup file**. Enter your password, then share the file to yourself (WhatsApp, Drive or email).
2. Laptop: download the file, then **Backup & sync → Open a backup file**. Enter the password it was made with and choose **Merge**.

Merge adds what's missing and never removes anything. Accounts and categories with the same name are joined, not duplicated. Deletions don't carry over; use **Replace** for an exact copy.

"I got a new phone."

Email a fresh backup to yourself. Install the app on the new phone and open it from its icon. Tap **Restore from a backup file** and enter that backup's password. Erase the old phone only once **Backup & sync** shows the same entry count on both.

"How do I get app updates?"

Nothing to do. Open the app while online and it updates itself. If it looks unchanged, close it fully and open it again.

Good habit

Make a backup every 1–2 weeks and keep the latest file in two places, such as Google Drive and your laptop. Home reminds you after 14 days without one.

8 · Security & emergencies

"Someone is looking at my screen."

Tap 👁 at the top to blur every amount; hold an amount to peek. Tap 🔒 to lock instantly.

"I want it to lock faster."

Settings → Auto-lock after (1–30 minutes). Also tick *Lock as soon as I switch to another app*. The app always locks when reopened or reloaded.

"My phone was lost or stolen."

Your data on it is encrypted, so without your master password it's unreadable. Restore your latest backup on a new device (section 7). If you think someone saw your password, restore on the new device and then **Settings → Change master password**.

"I forgot my master password."

It can't be recovered. On the unlock screen, tap **Forgot password?** to erase the vault. Then restore a backup file, using the password that backup was made with, or start fresh.

"Too many wrong passwords."

After 3 wrong tries the app makes you wait a few seconds, and the wait doubles each time. This slows down anyone guessing.

Protected

All data is encrypted with AES-256 on your device. Nothing is sent to any server. There are no ads or trackers. Backup files are encrypted.

Not protected

Someone using your phone while the app is unlocked, malware on your phone, and CSV exports, which are plain text.

9 · Quick reference

Words used in the app

Transfer	Money moving between your own accounts (ATM, card bill, wallet top-up). Not spending.
Balance correction	Added by *Update balance* so the app matches your bank. Not spending.
Split	One payment divided across several categories.
Unbilled	Card spending since the last statement date.
Limit used	Card amount owed ÷ credit limit.
Net worth	Everything you own minus card and loan dues.
Rollover	Unspent budget added to next month's limit.
Safe to spend / day	Budget left ÷ days left in the month.
Month starts on	The day your budget month begins, such as salary day.
Settle up	Recording that a friend paid you back, or you paid them. Not spending.
Your share	The part of a shared bill that counts as your spending.
Merge / Replace	Backup options: add what's missing, or make an exact copy.

Handy tricks

- Type sums in any amount box: **1200/3**, **450+120+80**.
- **Save & add another** keeps the account and date for fast entry.
- In Reports, tap a category to see its entries.
- Tap a bill on Home to jump to its account; tap **Net worth** to open Accounts.
- Features you don't use can be switched off in **Settings → Features**. Their data is kept.

Want a change?

Ask Claude to add, change or remove any feature. The app is built so each feature is a separate part, and updates reach your phone automatically.